ENG522-Glossary

❖ **applied linguistics**

The application of insights from theoretical linguistics to practical matters such as language teaching, remedial linguistic therapy, language planning or whatever.

❖ **arbitrariness**

An essential notion in structural linguistics which denies any necessary relationship between linguistic signs and their referents, e.g. objects in the outside world.

❖ **areas of linguistics**

Any of a number of areas of study in which linguistic insights have been brought to bear, for instance sociolinguistics in which scholars study society and the way language is used in it. Other examples are psycholinguistics which is concerned with the psychological and linguistic development of the child.

❖ **Chronology**

Content may be sequenced according to the order in which events occur in the real world. For example, in a writing course the organization might be based on the sequence writers are assumed to employ when composing: (1) brainstorming; (2) drafting; (3) revising; (4) editing. In a proficiency course, skills might be sequenced according to the sequence in which they are normally acquired: (1) listening; (2) speaking; (3) reading; (4) writing.

❖ **competence**

According to Chomsky in his Aspects of the theory of syntax (1965) this is the abstract ability of an individual to speak the language which he/she has learned as native language in his/her childhood. The competence of a speaker is unaffected by such factors as nervousness, temporary loss of memory, speech errors, etc. These latter phenomena are entirely within the domain of performance which refers to the process of applying one's competence in the act of speaking. Bear in mind that competence also refers to the ability to judge if a sentence is grammatically well-formed; it is an unconscious ability.

❖ **context**

A term referring to the environment in which an element (sound, word, phrase) occurs. The context may determine what elements may be present, in which case one says that there are 'co-occurrence restrictions' for instance 1) /r/ may not occur after /s/ in a syllable in English, e.g. */sri:n/ is not phonotactically permissible in English; 2) the progressive form cannot occur with stative verbs, e.g. We are knowing German is not well-formed in English.

❖ **contrast**

A difference between two linguistic items which can be exploited systematically. The distinction between the two forms arises from the fact that these can occupy one and the same slot in a syntagm, i.e. they alternate paradigmatically, e.g. the different inflectional forms of verbs contrast in both English and German. Forms which contrast are called distinctive. This can apply to sounds as well, for instance /p/ and /b/ contrast in English as minimal pairs such as pin /p?n/ : bin/b?n/ show.

convention

An agreement, usually reached unconsciously by speakers in a community, that relationships are to apply between linguistic items, between these and the outside world or to apply in the use of rules in the grammar of their language.

❖ **Course Planning**

A number of different levels of planning and development are involved in developing a course or set of instructional materials based on the aims and objectives that have been established for a language program.

❖ **creativity**

An accepted feature of human language — deriving from the phenomenon of sentence generation — which accounts for speakers' ability to produce and to understand a theoretically infinite number of sentences.

❖ **descriptive**

An approach to linguistics which is concerned with saying what language is like and not what it should be like (prescriptivism).

❖ **diachronic**

Refers to language viewed over time and contrasts with synchronic which refers to a point in time. This is one of the major structural distinctions introduced by Saussure and which is used to characterise types of linguistic investigation.

❖ **displacement**

One of the key characteristics of human language which enables it to refer to situations which are not here and now, e.g. I studied linguistics in London when I was in my twenties.

❖ **duality of patterning**

A structural principle of human language whereby larger units consist of smaller building blocks, the number of such blocks being limited but the combinations being almost infinite. For instance all words consist of combinations of a limited number of sounds, say about 40 in either English or German. Equally all sentences consist of structures from a small set with different words occupying different points in the structures allowing for virtually unlimited variety.

❖ **economy**

A principle of linguistic analysis which demands that rules and units are to be kept to a minimum, i.e. every postulated rule or unit must be justified linguistically by capturing a generalisation about the language being analysed, if not about all languages.

❖ **Effective Teaching**

Quality teaching is achieved not only as a consequence of how well teachers teach but through creating contexts and good.

❖ **extralinguistic**

Any phenomenon which lies outside of language. An extralinguistic reason for a linguistic feature would be one which is not to be found in the language itself.

❖ **figurative**

Any use of a word in a non-literal sense, e.g. at the foot of the mountain where foot is employed figuratively to indicate the bottom of the mountain. Figurative usage is the source of the second meaning of polysemous words.

❖ **formalist**

An adjective referring to linguistic analyses which lay emphasis on relatively abstract conceptions of language structure.

❖ **general linguistics**

A broad term for investigations which are concerned with the nature of language, procedures of linguistic analysis, etc. without considering to what use these can be put. It contrasts explicitly with applied linguistics.

❖ **generative**

A reference to a type of linguistic analysis which relies heavily on the formulation of rules for the exhaustive description (generation) of the sentences of a language.

❖ **head**

The centre of a phrase or sentence which is possibly qualified by further optional elements, in the phrase these bright new signs the head is signs as all other elements refer to it and are optional. The term is also used in lexicology to refer to the determining section of a compound; in family tree, the element tree is head and family is modifier. This has consequences for grammar, especially in synthetic languages, such as German where in a compound like Stammbuch the gender is neuter (with das) because the head Buch is although the modifying word is masculine (der Stamm).

❖ **hierarchy**

Any order of elements from the most central or basic to the most peripheral, e.g. a hierarchy of word classes in English would include nouns and verbs at the top and elements like adjectives and adverbs further down with conjunctions and subordinators still further down. The notions of top and bottom are intended in a metaphorical sense.

❖ **idealisation**

A situation where the linguist chooses to ignore details of language use for reasons of greater generalisation.

❖ **language**

A system which consists of a set of symbols (sentences) — realised phonetically by sounds — which are used in a regular order to convey a certain meaning. Apart from these formal characteristics, definitions of languages tend to highlight other aspects such as the fact that language is used regularly by humans and that it has a powerful social function.

❖ **lay speaker**

A general term to refer to an individual who does not possess linguistic training and who can be taken to be largely unaware of the structure of language.

❖ **level**

A reference to a set of recognisible divisions in the structure of natural language. These divisions are largely independent of each other and are characterised by rules and regularities of organisation. Traditionally five levels are recognised: phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics. Pragmatics may also be considered as a separate level from semantics. Furthermore levels may have subdivisions as is the case with morphology which falls into inflectional and derivational morphology (the former is concerned with grammatical endings and the latter with processes of word-formation). The term 'level' may also be taken to refer to divisions within syntax in generative grammar.

❖ **linguistic determinism**

Refers to the view, propounded by Edward Sapir and Benjamin Lee Whorf, that language determines the way in which people think. Also termed the linguistic relativity hypothesis.

❖ **linguistics**

The study of language. As a scientific discipline built on objective principles, linguistics did not develop until the beginning of the 19th century. The approach then was historical as linguists were mainly concerned with the reconstruction of the Indo-European language. With the advent of structuralism at the beginning of the 20th century, it became oriented towards viewing language at one point in time. The middle of this century saw a radically new approach — known as generative grammar — which stressed our unconscious knowledge of language and underlying structures to be found in all languages.

❖ **marked**

A term used to state that a particular form is statistically unusual or unexpected in a certain context. For instance zero plurals in English such as sheep or deer are marked.

❖ **metalanguage**

The language which is used to discuss language; see also object language.

❖ **metaphor**

An application of a word to another with which it is figuratively but not literally associated, e.g. food for thought. This process is very common in the use of language and may lead to changes in grammar as with the verb go in English where its spatial meaning has come to be used metaphorically for temporal contexts as in He's going to learn Russian.

❖ **Need Analysis**

Needs are often described in terms of a linguistic deficiency, that is, as describing the difference between what a learner can presently do in a language and what he or she should be able to do.

❖ **Needs**

Content may be sequenced according to when learners are most likely to need it outside of the classroom. For example, the rationale for the sequencing of content in a social survival curriculum is given as follows: The topics and cross-topics in the curriculum are sequenced "in order of importance to students' lives, ease of contextualization and their relationship to other topics and cross-topics."

❖ **onomastics**

The linguistic study of names, both personal and place names. This field is particularly concerned with etymology and with the general historical value of the information which names offer the linguist.

❖ **paradigm**

The set of forms belonging to a particular word-class or member of a word-class. A paradigm can be thought of as a vertical list of forms which can occupy a slot in a syntagm. Pronounced [?pær?daim].

❖ **parameter**

Any aspect of language which can obtain a specific value in a given language, e.g. canonical word-order which can have the verb in a declarative sentence either before the subject, after the subject or after both subject and object. Contrast principle in this respect.

❖ **performance**

The actual production of language as opposed to the knowledge about the structure of one's native language which a speaker has internalised during childhood (see Competence).

❖ **productivity**

A reference to the extent that a given process is not bound in its application to a certain input. For instance the prefixation of re- to verbs in modern English is productive because this can be done with practically all verbs, e.g. re-think, re-do, re-write. The term also refers — in syntax — to the ability of speakers to produce an unlimited number of sentences using a limited set of structures.

- **psychological reality**

The extent to which the constructs of linguistic theory can be taken to have a basis in the human mind, i.e. to somehow be reflected in human cognitive structures. Many linguists are divided on this issue, one extreme claiming that this requirement of a theory is not necessary, other saying that it is the ultimate test of any respectable theory.

- **reflexiveness**

The possibility of using language to talk about language; this is one of its delimiting characteristics with respect to other communication systems.

- **rhetoric**

The technique of speaking effectively in public. Regarded in the past as an art and cultivated deliberately.

- **Sapir-Whorf hypothesis**

The notion that thought is determined by language. While few linguists nowadays accept this strict link, there would seem to be some truth to the postulation of the two American anthropologists/linguists.

- **Situational Analysis**

Situation analysis is an analysis of factors in the context of a planned or present curriculum project that is made in order to assess their potential impact on the project. These factors may be politic, social, economic, or institutional.

- **Teaching Materials**

Teaching materials are a key component in most language programs. Whether the teacher uses a textbook, institutionally prepared materials, or his or her own materials, instructional materials generally serve as the basis for much of the language input learners receive and the language practice that occurs in the classroom.

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❖ **Adjacency pairs**

An adjacency pair is a unit of conversation that contains an exchange of one turn each by two speakers. The turns are functionally related to each other in such a fashion that the first turn requires a certain type or range of types of second turn.

❖ **Big "C" Conversations (Tools of Inquiry)**

"Conversations" (with a capital "C") are debates in society or within specific social groups (over focused issues like smoking, abortion, or school reform) that large numbers of people recognize, both in terms of what "sides" there are to take in such debates and what sorts of people tend to be on each side.

❖ **Collocational Patterns**

Any pattern of words or grammatical structures (types of words and phrases and clauses) that "hang together" to betoken a particular social language (and the identity associated with it) in the way in which sun hat, swimsuit, sunscreen, a towel, and flip-flops "hang together" to betoken a "sunbather."

❖ **Conversational Analysis**

A detailed form of discourse analysis that sees conversation as the basic human communicational form and seeks to explicate how people produce and reproduce social order through talk and orientation to talk and each other in social interaction. The approach is almost always just spelled as "CA" and is a branch of sociology (one that gives up building grand sociological theories in favor of describing the order people actually create and how they create and sustain that order). Manny Schegloff at the University of California at Los Angeles is the best living practitioner of CA.

❖ **Critical Discourse Analysis**

Any form of discourse analysis that seeks to engage with politics (see the Glossary entry for "politics"). Critical discourse analysis deals with whose "interests" are represented, helped, or harmed as people speak and write. When "critical discourse analysis" is spelled as "CDA" it often refers to the work of Norman Fairclough and his associates.

❖ **Eliciting Exchange**

The most common exchange in the classroom is an eliciting exchange (Willis, 1992, pg.113). These exchanges begin with the teacher asking a question (usually one they already know the answer to).

- **Identity**

A word used for lots of different things. What I mean by it in this book is this: Different ways of being in the world at different times and places for different purposes; for example, ways of being a "good student," an "avid bird watcher," a "mainstream politician," a "tough cop," a video-game "gamer," a "Native American," and so on and so forth through a nearly endless list. I do not mean your core sense of self, who you take yourself "essentially" to be, though that is an important notion as well. I often use the term "socially situated identity" or "social identity" instead of just the word "identity" to make clear I am talking about how we recognize and act out different social roles or different social positions in society.

- **language Function**

A language function refers to what students do with language as they engage with content and interact with others.

- **Minimal Responses**

Responses such as mmmm and yeah are known as minimal responses.

- **Semiotics**

A term for the study of sign systems.

- **Sign**

Any word or symbol (which could be an image or object) that has meaning (stands for something else thanks to a given concept, interpretation, and convention which relates to the sign and the thing it stands for).

- **Textual Pattern**

A level of interpretation which we are involved in as we process texts is that of recognizing textual pattern.

- **Utterance-Token Meaning**

It refers to "situated meaning".

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❖ **Coherence**

Coherence refers to the quality of being logical and consistent, e.g., 'This essay, on the whole, lacks coherence'.

❖ **Context Models**

Context models are special kinds of experience models. They represent communicative episodes in which we participate, often as part of other everyday episodes (conversation at breakfast, meeting at work, etc.).

❖ **Conversation Analysis**

Conversation analysis (CA) is an approach to the study of social interaction, embracing both verbal and non-verbal conduct, in situations of everyday life.

❖ **Critical Linguistics**

Critical Linguistics (CL) is "an approach to language study which uses linguistic techniques to investigate the ideologies (value systems and sets of beliefs) which underlie texts"

❖ **Dialectical Relational Approach**

According to Dialectical Relational Approach CDA is based upon a view of semiosis as an irreducible element of all material social processes (Williams 1977). Semiosis is viewed as an element of the social process which is dialectically related to others.

❖ **Dialectics**

Dialectics: The art or practice of arriving at the truth by the exchange of logical arguments.

❖ **Discourse**

Discourse is a unit of language usually longer than a sentence but the deduced meaning is beyond the level of sentence.

❖ **Interpersonal Meanings**

The interpersonal meanings are concerned with the interaction between speaker(s) and addressee(s).

❖ **Lexicon**

A lexicon is the knowledge that a native speaker has about a language.

❖ Mental Model

A mental model is an explanation of someone's thought process about how something works in the real world.

❖ SFL

Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) is an approach to linguistics that considers language as a social semiotic system.

❖ Situation Models

Situation models represent the situation a discourse is about, refers to and hence may also be called semantic models.

❖ Systematic Functional Linguistics

Systemic functional linguistics (SFL) is an approach to linguistics that considers language as a social semiotic system.

❖ The Discourse-Historical Approach

The Discourse-Historical Approach considers discourse analysis not just to be a method of language analysis, but a multidimensional project incorporating theory, methods, methodology and empirically based research practices that yield concrete social applications.

❖ Turn taking

The end of one speaker’s turn and the beginning of the next’s frequently latch on to each other with almost perfect precision and split-second timing.

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- **Acquire**

Acquire: learn or develop (a skill, habit or quality).

- **Aficionados**

Aficionados: a person who is very knowledgeable and enthusiastic about an activity, subject, or pastime.

- **Avatars**

Avatars: an icon or figure representing a particular person in a video game, internet forum, etc.

- **Assessment**

Assessment: the action of assessing someone or something.

- **Asynchronous**

Asynchronous: not existing or occurring at the same time.

- **Audio graphic**

Audio graphic: The use of telecommunication technology to transmit audio and (prepared or real-time) graphics together.

- **Accessible**

Accessible: able to be reached or entered.

- **Affiliations**

Affiliations: the state or relation of being closely associated or affiliated with a particular person, group, party, company, etc.

- **Autonomy**

Autonomy: the quality or state of being self-governing

- **Annotations**

Annotations: short explanation or note added to a text or image, or the act of adding short explanations or notes.

- **Anticipated**

Anticipated: regards as probable; expect or predict.

- **Audiovisual**

Audiovisual: is electronic media possessing both a sound and a visual component, such as slide-tape presentations, films & television programs.

- **Analogous**

Analogous: comparable in certain respects, typically in a way which makes clearer the nature of the things compared.

- **Algorithm**

Algorithm: a process or set of rules to be followed in calculations or other problem-solving operations, especially by a computer.

- **Applied linguistics**

Applied linguistics: is an interdisciplinary field which identifies, investigates, and offers solutions to language-related real-life problems.

- **Anecdotal**

Anecdotal: based on or consisting of reports or observations of usually unscientific observers.

- **Burgeoning**

Burgeoning: beginning to grow or increase rapidly; flourishing.

- **Blog**

Blog: is a frequently updated web page used for personal commentary or business content.

- **Bibliophile**

Bibliophile: a person who collects or has a great love of books.

- **Blended learning**

Blended learning: technology-mediated instruction, web-enhanced instruction, or mixed-mode instruction.

- **Contemporary**

Contemporary: a person or thing living or existing at the same time as another.

- **Collaboration**

Collaboration: the action of working with someone to produce something.

- **Cognitive limitations**

Cognitive limitations: limited skills related to planning, decision-making, and coping.

❖ **Constellations**

Constellations: a group of stars forming a recognizable pattern that is traditionally named after its apparent form or identified with a mythological figure.

❖ **Consolidation**

Consolidation: the action or process of making something stronger or more solid.

❖ **Cost-effectiveness**

Cost-effectiveness: Cost-effectiveness means that the product meets all of the desired specifications at a price that is competitive.

❖ **Curriculum**

Curriculum: the subjects comprising a course of study in a school or college.

❖ **Cognitive**

Cognitive: of, relating to, being, or involving conscious intellectual activity (such as thinking, reasoning, or remembering).

❖ **Concordance**

Concordance: is an alphabetical list of the principal words used in a book or body of work / agreement or consistency.

❖ **Criterion**

Criterion: a principle or standard by which something may be judged or decided.

❖ **Digitization**

Digitization: the process of converting information into a digital format.

❖ **Dyadic**

Dyadic: of or consisting of a dyad; being a group of two.

❖ **Enthusiasm**

Enthusiasm: intense and eager enjoyment, interest, or approval.

❖ **E-books**

E-books: an electronic version of a printed book that can be read on a computer or a specifically designed handheld device.

❖ **Ecology**

Ecology: the study of the relationships and their physical environment.

❖ **Encompassing**

Encompassing: include / comprehend.

- **Embedded**

Embedded: existing or firmly attached within something or under a surface.

- **Epistemological**

Epistemological: relating to the theory of knowledge.

- **Extrapolate**

Extrapolate: to estimate something or form an opinion about something.

- **E-Assessment**

E-Assessment: evaluation that is created, written, delivered and marked with technology.

- **Emergentism**

Emergentism: the belief in emergence, particularly as it involves consciousness and the philosophy of mind.

- **Fictionally**

Fictionally: of, relating to, characterized by, or occurring in fiction : invented by the imagination.

- **Fantasy-inspired**

Fantasy-inspired: To form or conceive fancifully or fantastically; form a mental picture of; imagine.

- **Gamification**

Gamification: the incorporation of game-style incentives into everyday or non-game activities.

- **Hybrid**

Hybrid: of mixed character; composed of different elements.

- **Hierarchically**

Hierarchically: a system in which things are put at various levels or ranks according to their importance.

- **Hypotheses**

Hypotheses: a supposition or proposed explanation made on the basis of limited evidence as a starting point for further investigation.

- **Interactive**

Interactive: mutually or reciprocally active.

❖ **Interchangeable**

Interchangeable: able to be exchanged with each other without making any difference or without being noticed.

❖ **Incorporate**

Incorporate: take in or contain (something) as part of a whole; include.

❖ **Intercultural**

Intercultural: taking place between cultures, or derived from different cultures.

❖ **Immersion**

Immersion: the act of dipping something in a substance, completely covering it, deep mental involvement in something.

❖ **Interoperability**

Interoperability: the ability of computer systems or software to exchange and make use of information.

❖ **Innovation**

Innovation: it can refer to something new, such as an invention, or the practice of developing and introducing new things.

❖ **Intimidating**

Intimidating: having a frightening, overawing, or threatening effect.

❖ **Interlocutors**

Interlocutors: someone who is involved in a conversation and who is representing someone else.

❖ **Inductive process**

Inductive process: a method of reasoning in which a general principle is derived from a body of observations. It consists of making broad generalizations based on specific observations

❖ **Idiosyncratic**

Idiosyncratic: a peculiarity of constitution or temperament : an individualizing characteristic or quality.

❖ **Longevity**

Longevity: long existence or service.

❖ **Lexical**

Lexical: relating to the words or vocabulary of a language.

❖ **Multimedia**

Multimedia: (of art, education, etc.) using more than one medium of expression or communication.

❖ **Multi-modal**

Multi-modal: characterized by several different modes of activity or occurrence.

❖ **Morphological**

Morphological: relating to the forms of words, in particular inflected forms.

❖ **Multidimensional**

Multidimensional: anything with many different parts or aspects.

❖ **Nebulous**

Nebulous: the form of a cloud or haze; hazy/ (of a concept) vague or ill-defined.

❖ **Multidisciplinary**

Multidisciplinary: combining or involving several academic disciplines or professional specializations in an approach to a topic or problem.

❖ **Meta-cognitive**

Meta-cognitive: refers to one's awareness and ability to regulate one's own thinking.

❖ **Neurobiological**

Neurobiological: a scientific field in which researchers study the nervous system and brain function.

❖ **Ontological**

Ontological: a branch of philosophy, is the science of what is, of the kinds and structures of objects. In simple terms, ontology seeks the classification and explanation of entities.

❖ **Psycho-linguistics**

Psycho-linguistics: concerned with the nature of the processes that the brain undergoes in order to comprehend and produce language

❖ **Peer support**

Peer support: encompasses a range of activities and interactions between people who share similar experiences.

❖ **Paradigm**

Paradigm: a typical example or pattern of something; a pattern or model.

❖ **Pedagogy**

Pedagogy: the method and practice of teaching, especially as an academic subject or theoretical concept.

- **Peer-to-peer interactions**

Peer-to-peer interactions: describes an approach to interaction and collaboration between participants in a shared project or activity.

- **Proliferation**

Proliferation: rapid increase in the number or amount of something.

- **Proprietary**

Proprietary: relating to an owner or ownership.

- **Pragmatics**

Pragmatics: the study of the practical aspects of human action and thought. the study of the use of linguistic signs, words and sentences, in actual situations.

- **Self-assessment**

Self-assessment: evaluation of oneself or one's actions, attitudes, or performance.

- **Smart whiteboard**

Smart whiteboard: also known as an electronic whiteboard, is a classroom tool that allows images from a computer screen to be displayed onto a classroom board using a digital projector.

- **Synchronous**

Synchronous: existing or occurring at the same time.

- **Socio-effective**

Socio-effective: A person's social environment, and social and effective characteristics, are important predictors of several psychological and coping difficulties.

- **Synchronize**

Synchronize: cause to occur or operate at the same time or rate.

- **Scaffold**

Scaffold: a raised wooden platform used formerly for the public execution of criminals/ a process through which a teacher adds supports for students in order to enhance learning and aid in the mastery of tasks.

- **Technology**

Technology: the application of scientific knowledge to the practical aims of human life.

❖ **Technology-mediated**

Technology-mediated: an 'umbrella' term, incorporating different approaches to using computers in learning and teaching.

❖ **Tele-collaboration**

Tele-collaboration: the use of computer and/or digital communication tools to promote learning through social interaction and collaboration, thus moving the learning process beyond the physical boundaries of classrooms.

❖ **Videoconferencing**

Videoconferencing: the holding of a conference among people at remote locations by means of transmitted audio and video signals.

❖ **Virtual**

Virtual: not physically existing as such but made by software to appear to do so.

❖ **Wizard**

Wizard: a helping feature of a software package that automates complex tasks by asking the user a series of easy-to-answer questions.

❖ **Web 2.0 Applications**

Web 2.0 Applications: websites and applications that make use of user-generated content for end-users. Web 2.0 is characterized by greater user interactivity and collaboration, more pervasive network connectivity and enhanced communication channels.

❖ **Zeitgeist**

Zeitgeist: the defining spirit or mood of a particular period of history as shown by the ideas and beliefs of the time.